Subject Evaluation Report BIOL340 Cell and Molecular Biology Autumn

Project Title: **Autumn 2025 - Subject and Lecturer Evaluations**

Subject Enrolments: **168**
Responses Received: **33**
Response Rate: **19.64%**

Report Comments

This report combines subject evaluation results for all instances where a subject is taught across multiple campuses or modes in a single session.

The report provides:

- SEBS response rate and basic respondent demographics
- Overall evaluation ratings and ratings for each question
- Comparisons with your school for the current session
- Free-text comments – providing valuable information on aspects important to students and suggestions for improvements.

If you have any questions about this report, contact uow-evaluations@uow.edu.au.

Interpreting the data

- Subject Instance Reports are generated only when six or more students complete the survey. However, the results for subjects with fewer than six respondents are included in the aggregate reports.
- Response rates of less than 10% should be interpreted with caution.
- A numeric value is assigned to each response. These are used to calculate the average (mean) for each question. Values assigned are:
  - Strongly Agree (6)
  - Agree (5)
  - Mildly Agree (4)
  - Mildly Disagree (3)
  - Disagree (2)
  - Strongly Disagree (1)
  - Unable to Judge (not counted)
- **An overall subject mean is calculated on the 10 core questions only** - Any additional questions included in the survey are not counted towards the mean.
- Mean scores can hide extremes in responses, as such, you are encouraged to also utilise response distribution and percentage agreeable metrics.

About the SEBS Survey

The SEBS survey has been designed as a tool to assist Subject Coordinators to evaluate their subject(s) in order to assess their impact on student learning. These reports should be compared with, and supported by, information obtained from other sources such as student focus groups, self-reflections and peer reviews. Subject Coordinators are asked to document their reflections (including identified actions to maintain and enhance subject quality) in the Subject Reflection Database on their Faculty Quality Assurance (QA) Moodle Site.

See the Evaluation of Learning and Teaching website for further information.

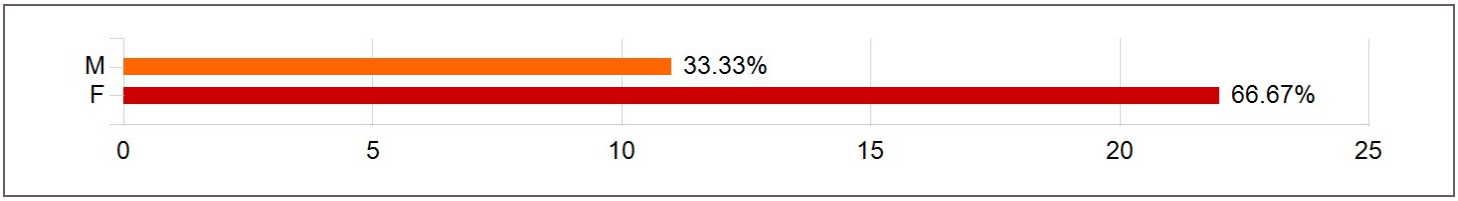
Closing the feedback loop

Let your students know what changes you make to the subject, in response to your reflections and feedback (including from the SEBS survey) in the next iteration of the Subject Outline.

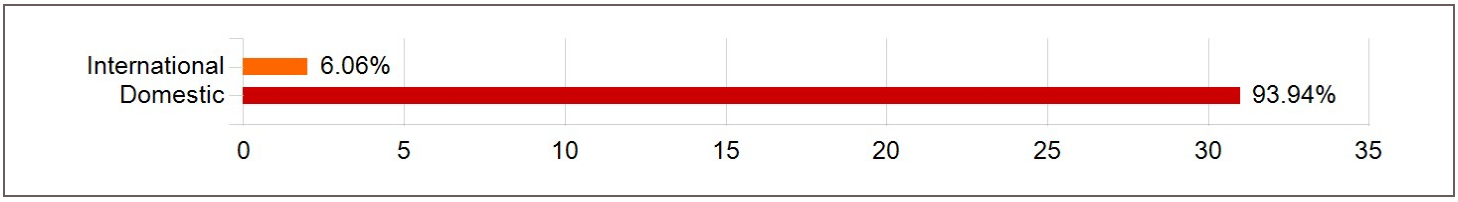
Creation Date: **Thursday, July 24, 2025**

About the Respondents

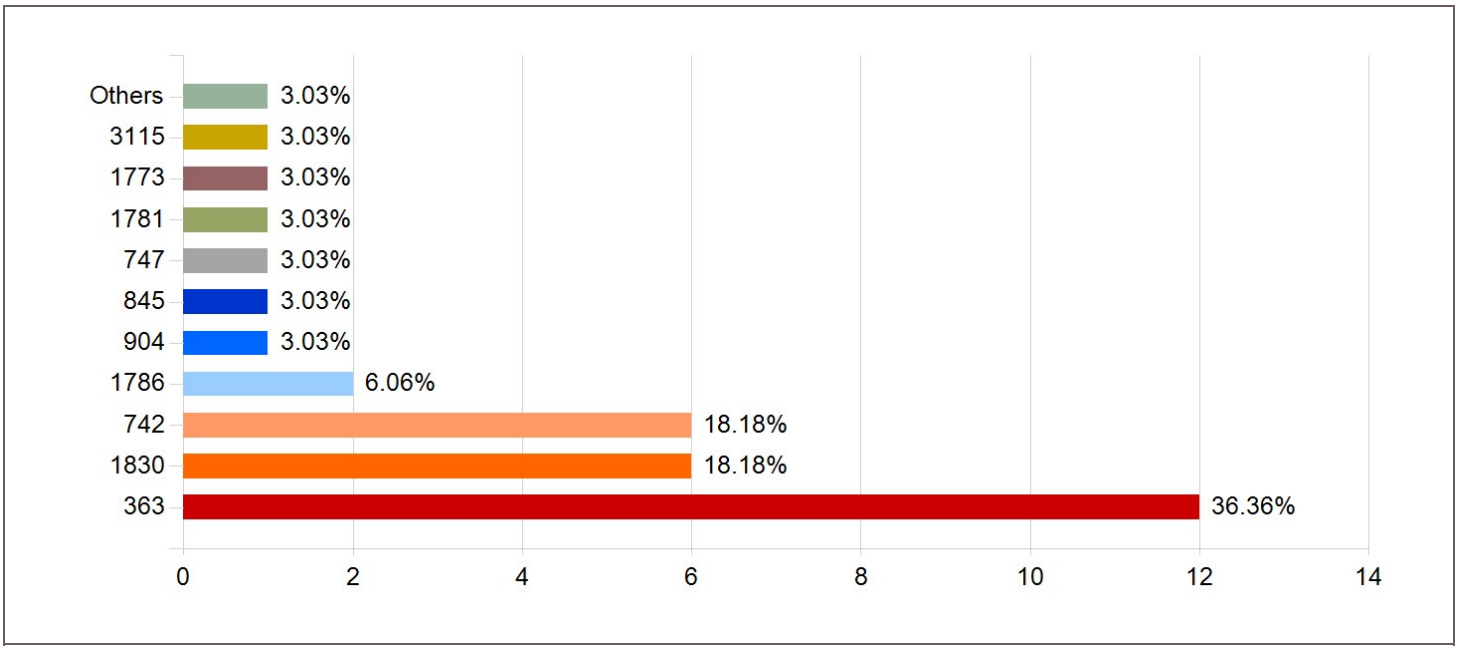
Gender breakdown



Domestic/International breakdown



Course breakdown



Reliability Assessment Score (RAS)

The RAS gives you an indication of the reliability of the data reflecting accurately the views of the student cohort. Results will be classified as insufficient, sufficient or good. Where scores are considered insufficient we encourage you to review the statistical information with caution and focus instead on the free text comments.

With 33 responses from a survey population of 168, the data presented in this report is considered to be **Sufficient**
Number of responses needed to be considered sufficient: 18
Number of responses needed to be considered good: 54

Results Summary

Note: The session average score includes all surveys completed across UOW for the current session

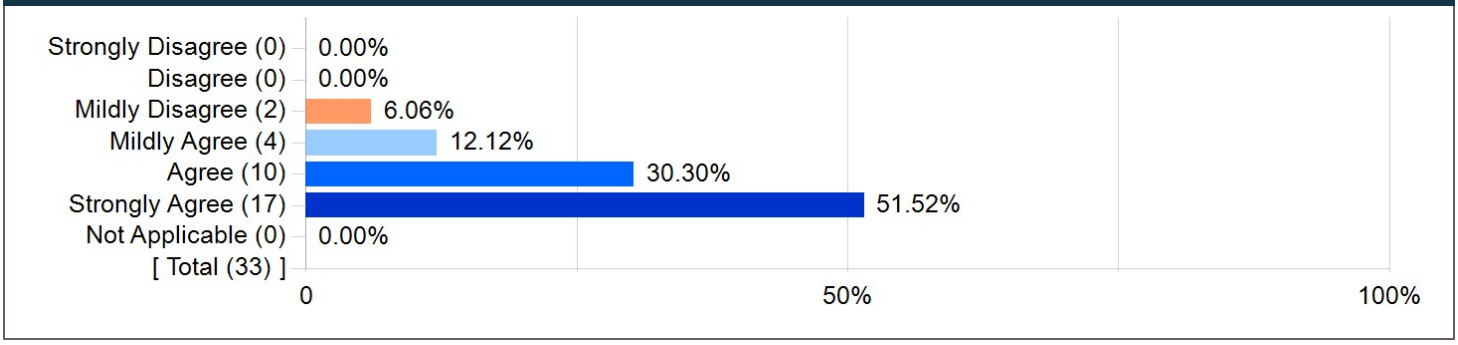
Subject Evaluation Questions

Note: The response count excludes 'Unable to Judge' responses

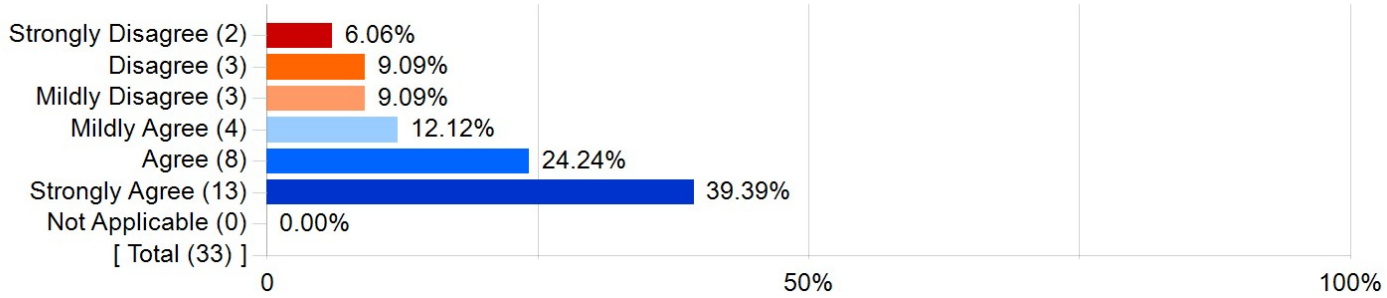
Question	Subject (BIOL340)				School (School of Science)			
	Response Count	Mean	Min	Max	Response Count	Mean	Min	Max
Understood subject requirements and learning outcomes	33	5.27	3.00	6.00	1230	5.27	1.00	6.00
Content organised in a clear and logical way	33	4.58	1.00	6.00	1233	5.14	1.00	6.00
Subject challenged my thinking	33	5.18	3.00	6.00	1230	5.39	1.00	6.00
Learning materials aided my learning	33	4.91	1.00	6.00	1229	5.25	1.00	6.00
Technology aided my learning	33	4.70	1.00	6.00	1230	5.18	1.00	6.00
Subject provided real world examples connecting theory and practice	33	4.94	2.00	6.00	1223	5.21	1.00	6.00
Assessment tasks clearly stated	33	4.30	1.00	6.00	1229	5.03	1.00	6.00
Clear connections between assessment tasks and subject learning outcomes	33	4.61	1.00	6.00	1225	5.20	1.00	6.00
Timely feedback helped my learning	32	4.56	1.00	6.00	1206	4.90	1.00	6.00
Overall satisfaction	33	4.55	1.00	6.00	1228	5.09	1.00	6.00
Overall Mean	-	4.76	-	-	-	5.17	-	-

Response Analysis - Core Questions

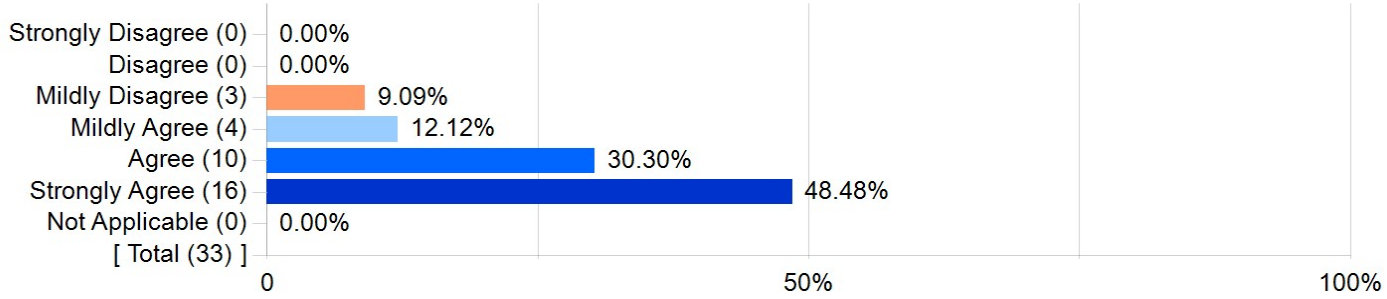
1. Understood subject requirements and learning outcomes



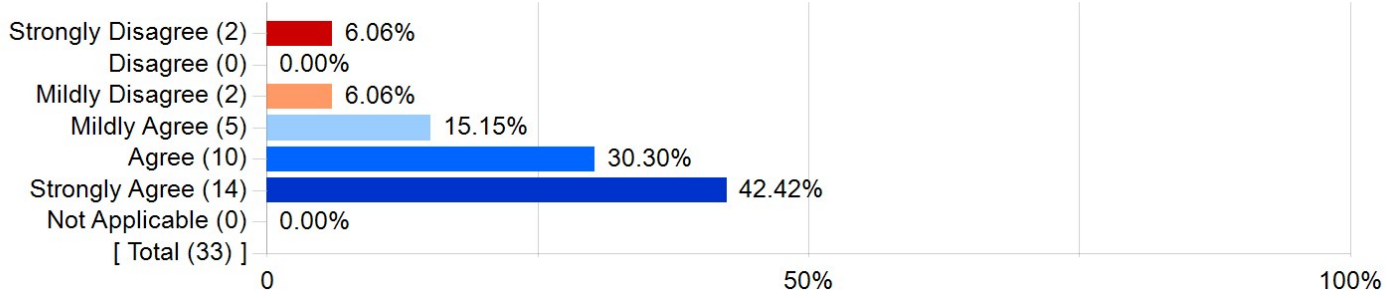
2. Content organised in a clear and logical way



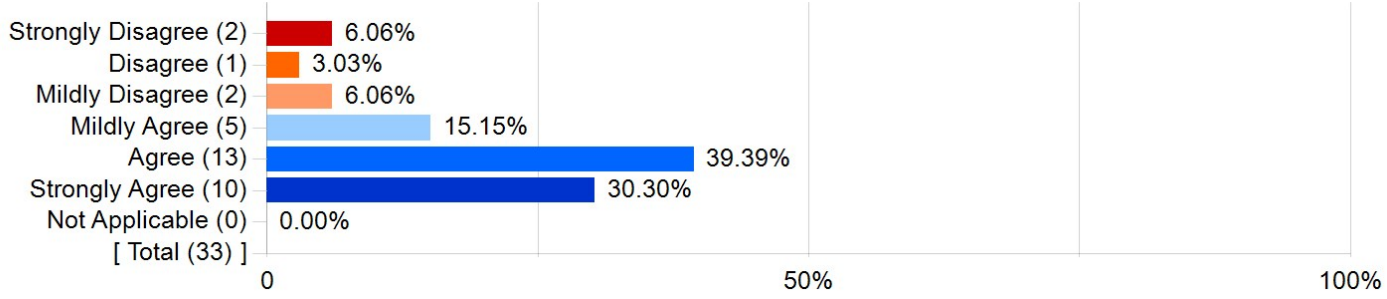
3. Subject challenged my thinking



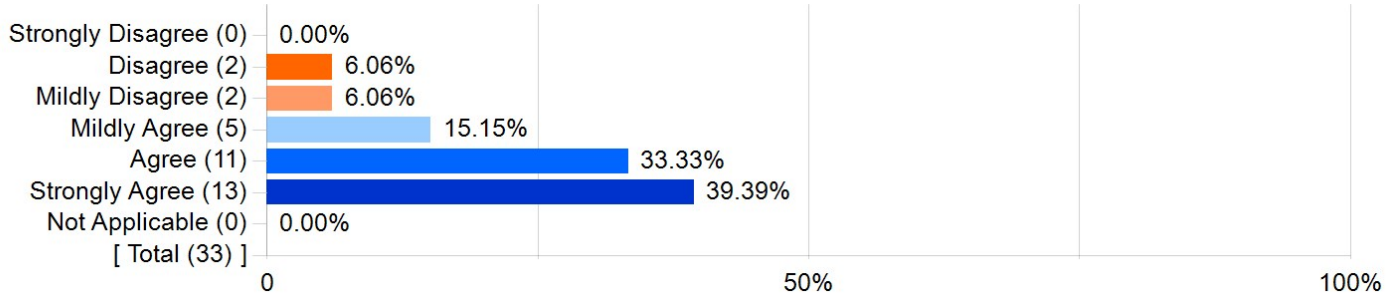
4. Learning materials aided my learning



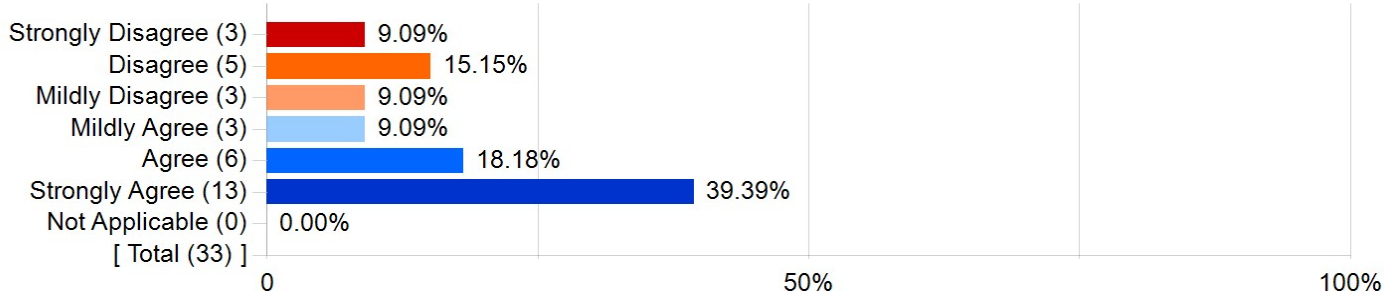
5. Technology aided my learning



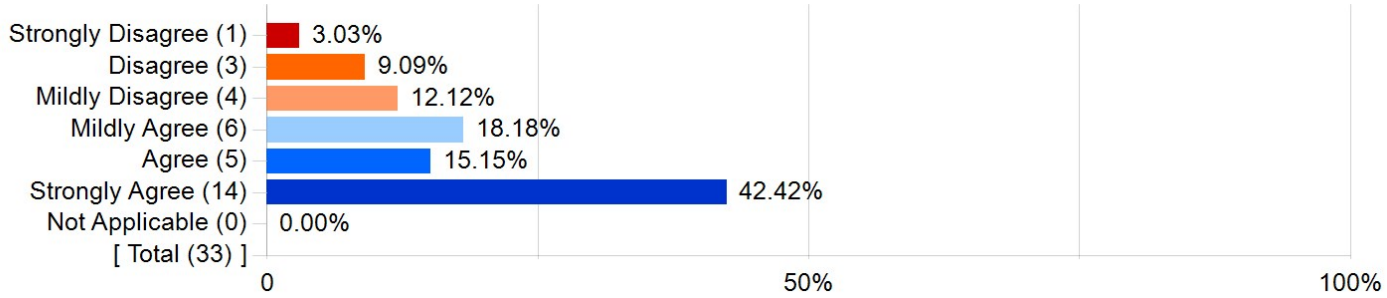
6. Subject provided real world examples connecting theory and practice



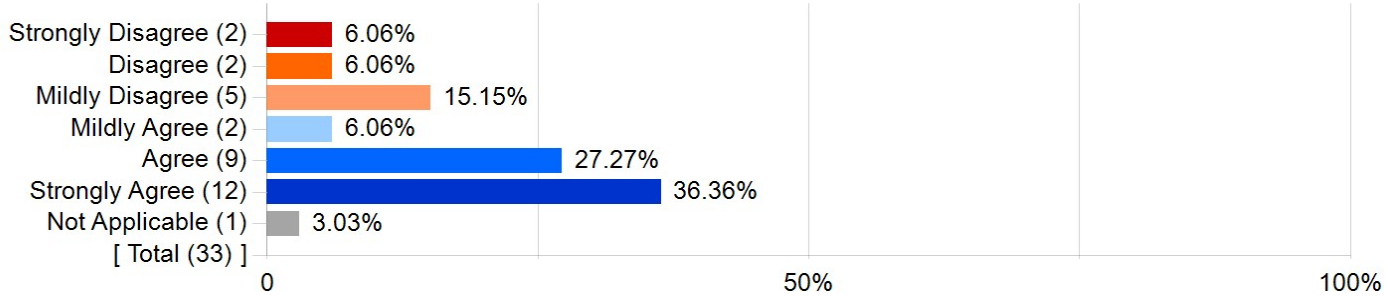
7. Assessment tasks clearly stated



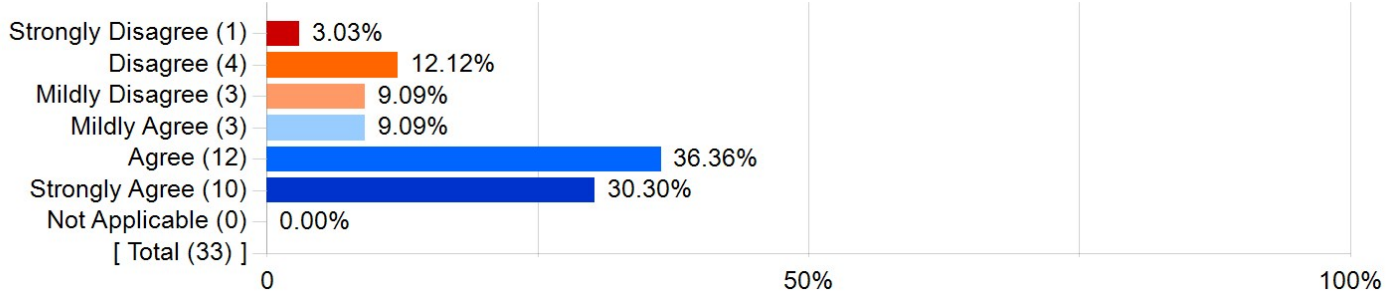
8. Clear connections between assessment tasks and subject learning outcomes



9. Timely feedback helped my learning

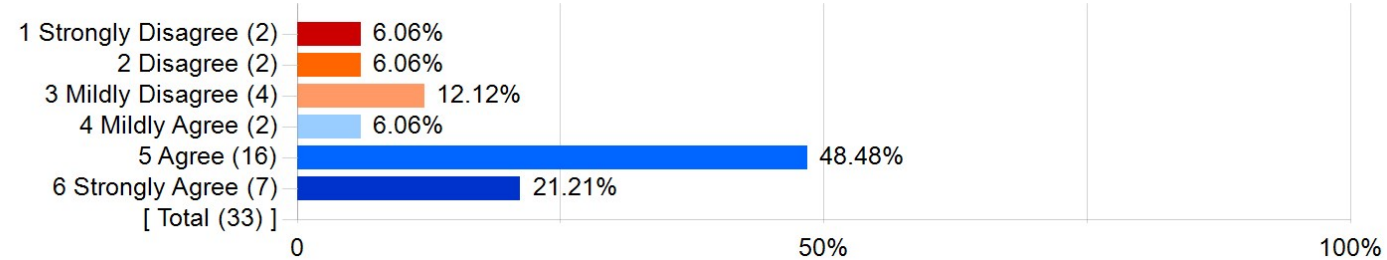


10. Overall satisfaction

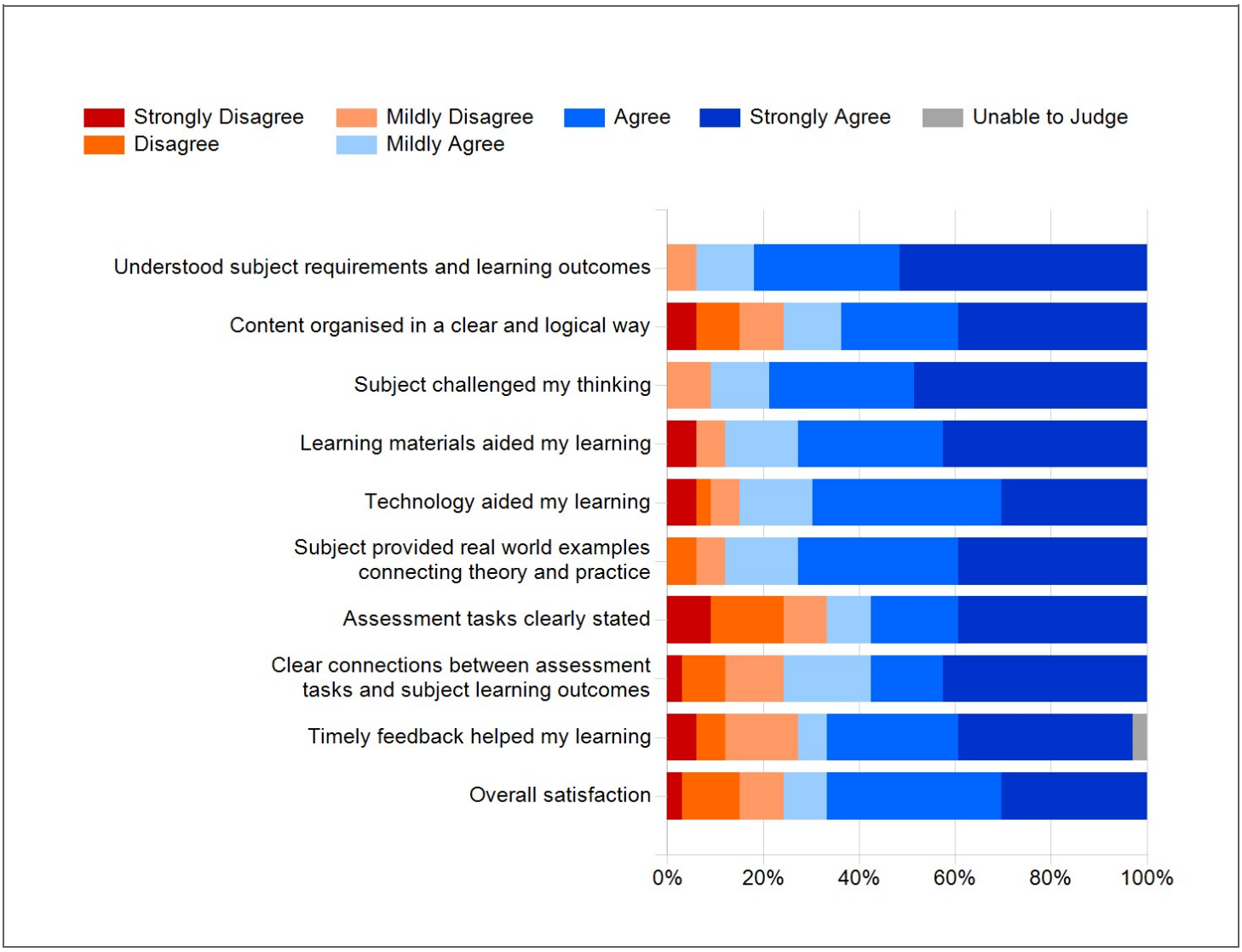


Strategic Initiative Questions

12. The Moodle site for this subject had a clear layout and was easy to navigate.



Response Distribution


Strongly Disagree
Disagree
Mildly Disagree
Mildly Agree
Agree
Strongly Agree
Unable to Judge
Understood subject requirements and learning outcomes
Content organised in a clear and logical way
Subject challenged my thinking
Learning materials aided my learning
Technology aided my learning
Subject provided real world examples connecting theory and practice
Assessment tasks clearly stated
Clear connections between assessment tasks and subject learning outcomes
Timely feedback helped my learning
Overall satisfaction
0%
20%
40%
60%
80%
100%

Breakdown of Responses by Campus

The table below shows the means for each campus across each of the core questions. Campuses only appear in the results when there were six (6) or more responses for that campus.

Subject Evaluation Questions

Campus	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	Q5	Q6	Q7	Q8	Q9	Q10
Overall	5.27	4.58	5.18	4.91	4.70	4.94	4.30	4.61	4.56	4.55
Wollongong	5.27	4.58	5.18	4.91	4.70	4.94	4.30	4.61	4.56	4.55

Response Analysis - % Agreeable

The table below shows the percentage of students who selected the option: Mildly Agree, Agree, Strongly Agree

Question	% Agreeable
Understood subject requirements and learning outcomes	93.94%
Content organised in a clear and logical way	75.76%
Subject challenged my thinking	90.91%
Learning materials aided my learning	87.88%
Technology aided my learning	84.85%
Subject provided real world examples connecting theory and practice	87.88%
Assessment tasks clearly stated	66.67%
Clear connections between assessment tasks and subject learning outcomes	75.76%
Timely feedback helped my learning	71.88%
Overall satisfaction	75.76%

Response Analysis for School - % Agreeable

The table below shows the percentage of students who selected the option: Mildly Agree, Agree, Strongly Agree

Question	% Agreeable
Understood subject requirements and learning outcomes	95.53%
Content organised in a clear and logical way	92.62%
Subject challenged my thinking	97.15%
Learning materials aided my learning	94.79%
Technology aided my learning	93.58%
Subject provided real world examples connecting theory and practice	94.28%
Assessment tasks clearly stated	89.10%
Clear connections between assessment tasks and subject learning outcomes	94.04%
Timely feedback helped my learning	88.14%
Overall satisfaction	92.35%

Qualitative comments

11. What were the best aspects of this subject and what changes would you suggest for this subject?

Comments
I enjoyed the content covered in this subject. The lecture topics were interesting. The labs linked to the content but at times dragged on. I liked how the mid–session and final exams were split up and thought they were a good difficulty. Not too difficult but challenged my thinking. I didn't enjoy the R studio part of the subject. It was very confusing without having coding/software development experience. It's really hard to understand without interest. There would need to be separate lectures or tutorials giving some explanation of R, but this is just added content to learn. I understand why we used R but at the same time I feel like we should've just stuck with excel because those doing science degrees have experience with excel from previous subjects. I wasn't too keen on the response time for the Moodle forum. The time it took to get responses was just too long in my opinion. I understand "admin" have their own personal lives and aren't available 24/7 but it did drag on. The feedback from the academics was rather brief for assessment 5. I found it vague and not super constructive.
The best aspects of the subject included the clear layout of lecture content and the use of learning outcomes and potential exam questions provided in the lectures. The labs also aligned somewhat with the lecture content, helping us understand key concepts in more detail. To improve the subject, responding to emails and the student forum on Moodle in a more timely manner could aid in communicating expectations for assessment tasks and providing further feedback on assessments. Furthermore, opening the post–lab quizzes after the due date has passed to allow people to review their work and improve on any information they got wrong. Changing the post–lab quizzes to ensure that each question is worth 1 mark rather than a one answer multiple choice question being worth 8 marks, as when people get this wrong it can significantly impact their mark even if they made a small error on the last step of a calculation for example. Also, the post–lab quizzes often had questions about things we had not encountered in the labs nor lecture content, especially the first quiz, which made them more difficult to do well, especially considering that we were unable to review our answers and what we got wrong afterwards. Moreover, having clear outline of assessment tasks would be beneficial, as in some information provided in the rubric for the scientific report did not align with what was communicated, resulting in many students losing a lot of marks (for example citations and references in APA7 as stated in the rubric vs Harvard as stated on the Moodle forum the day before the assessment was due). Further monitoring of peer feedback could also be beneficial for the scientific lab report task, as some students were quite harsh in their marking and feedback.
Organised lecture content, logically follows flow of information to make further lectures digestible. Less AI use would be better.
My favourite subject this sem!! Perfetto. Also best layout of a Moodle site I've seen so far.
this subject was pretty good and the lecturers were relatively interesting and enthusiastic. It did however seem pretty disjointed. Some weeks of lecture content seemed irrelevant and could've been better explained by a YouTube video. it also seemed that we were focusing to broadly, it wouldv'e been better to split it into clearer modules that perhaps delved deeper into one area than such a broad overview of any aspect
This subject was good in the way that we have already learnt most of the content in the first 2 years, but we were just adding small chunks and consolidating our previous knowledge. I may be wrong but it seemed to me like there was a lack of content for the lectures because they really didnt seem too relevant to the practicals. I considered the practicals to be the main part of the subject but didnt find much worth in the lectures because there was little demonstration of its importance. Having many lecturers also made it difficult to have consistent, well delivered content. A lot of the lecturers were unprepared and used slides that were not their own. They often lacked subject outcomes and a cohesive/chronological order. The wet practicals were delivered really well. The computer stuff was not necessary. We are not coding student, we don't do IT. It is a biology subject, not computer science. It was very unhelpful and actually made this subject unnecessarily more difficult. I was a prettybig consensus among students that the coding was completely irrelevant and because we were spending time and effort figuring that stuff out, we were not actually learning any biology. I get the subject lab person was a coding fanatic (good job, you definitely do a good job with computers) but most of us are directed towards the medical field; our brains cannot deal with that. It brought back memories from the first biochemistry subject and lab archives. The moodle page also lacked substance. It was very difficult to find information about our assessments. The small assessment presentation was not helful at all.
moodle site should be organised into weeks, makes it so much easier and all my other classes are organised this way
The subject was very unorganised – lecture content had no relation to lab experiments, making it very difficult to connect and solidify learning. Post–lab quizzes had information not present in either the lab information or the lecture slides and relied heavily on external research which was not helpful. Our lab demonstrator didn't understand the pracs and couldn't answer any questions we asked about method, structure etc. The scientific report assignment had unclear and poor instructions making it difficult to complete the task to the best of my ability.
doing labwork was the most fun aspect for me only change i would suggest would be more emphasis on how what we are doing will relate to work outside of uni
the lab and report task were enjoyable aspects of the subject. i would remove the dry lab component altogether or change it to an at

Comments
home task rather than in the lab.
I would change the Moodle site to have tabs based on weeks rather than content eg. having the lecture, practicals etc in a week 2 tab. While having all lectures, for example, does make them easier to find having all the practicals in one tab made it hard to find which practical whent with which week
labs and assessment layout was good. Lectures could be better
I think the content of the lectures was interesting and some practicals were fun I really really like the format of the midsession quiz. It made sense to me, was easy to navigate and made big questions feel manageable instead of overwhelming, allowing me to think through answers with enough time Assessment information: there was so much different information about the report, in so many different places, especially in regard to formatting, that it made it really difficult to follow and keep track of. Having talk to some peers I found that some only did small figure legends because they didnt even check the info, we checked one info that got changed and therefore lost marks for our figure legends, feels unfair Pracs: Didnt totally understand the point of the pracs apart from the first one and apoptosis. Felt like we did 3 pracs on cell viability but no actual link to anything. Genetics last year had a clear end goal of all pracs that was worked on throughout, this made it more enjoyable and felt like there was a purpose to being in class, this may be a good strategy to adopt for next year. Peer Marking: While i think that peer marking is valuable and has a place in uni and academia, I'm not sure doing so much of it is the way to go. Marking 1 or 2 other reports to then use these comments to revise a report and then have academic staff read it would be a personally preffered way to go about this. Marking 3 is lengthy and not everyone marks to the same standards. if peer marking is done I think clearer guidelines need to be set out for students, i.e. for what should people loose marks, what must they have to get a mark, if they dont mention x,y,z then they lose 0.5 of a mark, or if you are marking someone down you MUST leave a comment not just mark it down without giving any reasoning at all. AI usage: personally i dont like the use of AI to this level, while I think it has a place in study, I personally think it's trash for the environment and not wholly necessary
The Ai reflection was useful and a good way of managing the tools available to us, but I didn’t feel it deserved as much attention as it got in the subject. The report writing was helpful and improved my skills and confidence in bring my various skills together into one project. Overall the pracs were pretty good and aided in my learning, the exams were really well designed and I was impressed with them as an assessment they really tested my understanding
Changes would include fixing the way instructors and Moodle teach student how to use R studio, as the dry practicals were next to useless with Rstudio only just working for some codes.
CHANGES; – there was limited communication between the academic team and students; thus, there was consistent confusion and a lack of complete understanding surrounding assessments/work. – the practicals were hard to understand and navigate – it felt as though no one knew what was going on (both in written form and verbal assistance.) – there was no clear guidance for assessments – the marking rubric and assessment outlines were vague.
The lectures were engaging and had interesting connections to research and disease. The progression of lecture content was clear. I liked the report being between lab partners because it was easy to work on collaboratively with less people to organise. I would highly recommend being more active in the forum. Many times, in the lead up to assessments, forum questions were left unanswered or answered at the very last minute. This was both frustrating and stressful, because clarification on what was expected wasn't given. Additionally, more information on assessment expectations would be really useful. For instance, no information on the final exam's format was given. Being ambiguous made it hard to be sure that the work we were doing was correct. With extra guidance and outlines for assessments, the forum would also be less overwhelmed. In terms of the practicals, the wet practicals often tried to do too much with too little time, meaning experiments were rushed, incomplete or we had to stay back. The dry practicals were difficult, as most of us had never used coding software before, and demonstrators couldn't identify errors in the code to help us. I re–did entire coding notebooks multiple times because I wasn't equipped enough to understand what I was doing wrong.
Best Aspects – The core content that was presented – The practical aspects of the subject Improvements – Having assessment 4 be purely based off peer marking while good in theory, does not translate well to practice. There were so many people that did the bare minimum in the comments that they provided and didn't seem to actively engage with the report in a way that would allow for the fair and reasonable marking. Out of what, 9 criteria for the report, 4 of my commentors only gave three responses, with some not accurately representing what is displayed in the report, and areas that were marked down had not comments, so I had no idea what to improve on. One used AI to generate their comments which isn't fair given we needed these comments for Assessment 5 and the others comments didn't relate to the report at all. Having each criteria require a mandatory comment would alleviate some of this but further reinforcement of how these comments should be structured and the depth

Comments
required would also help. – Possibly separate the Moodle Page by week rather than 'lecture' and 'wet lab'. A lot of other subjects have it by week and it makes it easier to navigate the Moodle page.
This subject was very poorly organised and the communication was terrible. Questions/emails would go unanswered for over a week, and there would be many questions due to errors or confusing guidelines surrounding assessments. Assessments 4 + 5 in particular were overly frustrating and confusing, many of us felt that we did not fully understand the expectations/ guidelines for the assessments and the peer marking was wildly inaccurate and frustrating with little support from staff despite being promised that incorrect marks would be moderated. Additionally, post–lab quizzes were very confusing with no way to review the quizzes to see what we got wrong or where we could improve, and often questions would not be related to the lab or the information provided in prelabs/ lectures.
This subject has been incredibly fun and interesting, and I think there is very little change required to improve it. That being said, some improvements I would suggest are as follows: 1. Giving feedback via feedback fruits is great, but both partners having to do the same papers may give repetitive or redundant feedback as, if they work together, they tend to settle on the same feedback (could improve this by allowing partners to give feedback as a duo on more papers than currently, or by allowing individuals to mark papers at random regardless of their partner) 2. I really disliked the flipped lectures where the lectures were prerecorded and the live lectures only covered exam–style questions. I think these two things should be run together or in the opposite position (i.e. lectures live & questions prerecorded). I learn complex concepts much better when it is run through with me in person, so I struggled learning things like signal transduction due to this.
The best aspect of this subject was the labs. While at times they felt very lengthy during incubation periods, I found what we were doing in each lab very interesting and was good in bettering my lab skills for the future. I think something to alter slightly would be the use of R during our coding labs. I think some students were already familiar with the software which was great, but I found it hard to grasp with not previous experience with this software. It was very interesting to use and I think it should remain part of the course content but maybe only have one or two labs utilising it for smaller things would be more digestible.
The labs were really interesting and enjoyable, I would maybe try to encourage more interactivity between groups within them.

Session and Year Details : Autumn - 2025

Locations Included : Wollongong

Delivery modes: On Campus